California

California was the most populated cultural region because of the great climate and agricultural land prior to the arrival of the Europeans. Historians estimate that California had around 300,000 people living within its boundaries during the middle of the 16th century. It is believed that around one hundred tribes lived there and spoke over 200 different dialects. Most of these dialects originated from the Uto-Aztecan, Hokan and the Penutian languages. It is generally accepted that more languages were spoken in California than all of Europe at the time.

In spite of the vast amount of languages spoken in California, the tribes essentially lived in the same manner. They had created family units referred to as tribelets and relationships amongst them were peaceful for the most part. The Spanish arrived in the region during the mid-16th century with a vision of creating a civilization. They established a church in 1769 in modern day San Diego and enslaved the Native Americans to be used as laborers. The slaves suffered a similar fate to that of natives in other regions: they were either killed by disease or by being overworked.